

HE'S USING THE KIDS AGAINST YOU.

The lies he's feeding them.

The exact moves to protect your bond.

What to do tonight when they won't look at you the same.

READ THIS TWICE

You call. They don't answer. You show up. They turn away. "Mommy's bad" or "Daddy said you're mean." You hear your own words twisted in their mouths. You replay every moment hunting for the proof you didn't do this. At 11pm you're staring at the wall wondering if you're losing your kids forever.

Stop asking if you're the crazy one. That question was planted there on purpose. A woman who doubts herself is easier to isolate from her own children. What you're living is not "high conflict co-parenting." It's weaponized children. Control wearing the face of "for the kids."

THE TELL

If you have screenshots of messages where he badmouths you to them, if the kids suddenly repeat lies about you that only he could have said, if they refuse contact after time with him — that is not "kids being kids." That is your survival instinct flagging abuse by proxy.

This isn't a co-parenting guide. It's the deprogramming for when your children are the weapon.

STEP 1

Name the weaponization — out loud

Manipulation survives in the fog of "maybe it's just the divorce." Tick everything you lived with. Three or more is a pattern, not a bad season.

- Kids repeating his exact insults about you
- Sudden refusal to see you or talk after his time
- "Daddy said you don't love us" or "you left us"
- Messages used as proof against you in their ears
- Guilt trips through the kids ("tell mommy you want to live with daddy")
- Lies about money, other relationships, your home
- Kids acting as messengers or spies for him
- Rules made up to limit your time with them
- "You're the reason daddy is sad"
- Being told you're "unhinged" or "crazy" to the kids
- Feeling like you have to prove you're the good parent every visit

SAY IT

"What he's doing to our kids is not okay. I am not the person he's telling them I am. I will document, protect, and stay steady for them even when it hurts."

STEP 2

The lies are the strategy

He doesn't need to hit you anymore. He hits through their beliefs. The goal is to make you the villain so they choose him, or at least doubt you enough to give him control. Gaslighting through the kids is rarely loud. It's the thousand tiny corrections until their memory of you feels unreliable.

So you take your reality back, deliberately:

- Write it down, dated. A private note after every incident the kids repeat — what was said, what was done. Your notes don't gaslight you. Patterns don't lie.
- Believe the behavior, not the "I never said that." What they repeat after his time is evidence.
- Re-recruit your witnesses. Teachers, family, friends who see the real you. Tell them what's happening so the smear doesn't land.
- Your body kept score. The dread before drop-off, the relief when they return but the sadness in their eyes — that data is real.

THE ONE QUESTION

Stop asking "What did I do wrong?" Start asking: "Would I let someone do this to my sister's kids?" Your answer is the line you keep talking yourself out of.

STEP 3

Protect the bond without playing his game

He wants the reaction. The fight in front of kids. The desperate texts. The proof you're "unstable." Starve it. Manipulation needs a reaction to feed on.

- Use a parenting app or written only for all communication. Short, factual, boring. "Pickup at 5 as per order. Kids had good day." Nothing more.
- Pre-write responses for when kids say the lies. "I love you. I know daddy tells you different things. I'm here when you want the truth from me."
- Do not badmouth him back. It proves his point to them. Model the calm he can't touch.
- Gray rock the poison. When they repeat his words, acknowledge the feeling not the lie: "That sounds confusing and hard. I am your mom and I love you no matter what."
- Build small rituals that are only yours. Even 10 minutes of real connection without defending yourself.

SAY IT

"I am available to discuss the kids in writing only. I am not discussing the past or defending myself in this thread."

THE RULE

Every time you refuse to fight dirty through the kids, you give them a little more of the real you back. Silence on his terms is power.

STEP 4

Why it feels like you're losing them forever

The pull to "fix it" or "prove it" is strong. You want to explain, show proof, beg them to see. That's the hook. Weaponization runs on the same intermittent reinforcement as the original abuse. The rare good visit or "I love you mom" after the bad ones keeps you chasing.

- You are not losing them because you are bad. You are targeted because you are the threat to his control.
- Grieve the version of motherhood he stole, not the kids themselves. They are still in there under the poison.
- Play the long tape. Every lie he plants will one day need proof from you. Keep the record clean and steady.
- Do not collapse in front of them. Your steadiness is the antidote he can't replicate.

WHEN THE HOLE IN YOUR CHEST HITS

Call your person. Write the facts again. Do not text him or post. Move your body. The kids need the version of you who stays solid, not the one who breaks. A craving to "make them see" peaks for about 20 minutes, then fades. Don't act inside the wave.

YOU'RE GETTING YOUR KIDS' TRUST BACK

Take back what he took

They took your voice in your children's ears. Take it back, one steady sentence at a time:

- What is happening to our kids is real. I am not crazy or unhinged.
- I am allowed to document and protect without becoming the villain he paints.
- My love for them does not depend on their current words. It is bigger than the poison.
- I can be the calm parent they return to when the fog lifts.
- I do not have to win every battle in their heads tonight. I have to stay the safe one.

TONIGHT — ONE THING

Write down the three most recent lies the kids repeated and the exact source you suspect. Date it. Save it. That is your first piece of their future proof. Then say one sentence from the scripts out loud to yourself without softening.

You don't have to fix him. You have to stop letting him rewrite your children's memory of you. That is the entire work.

Please read this:

If this is escalating to threats, harassment, stalking, or you fear for the kids' safety, contact a lawyer immediately and domestic violence resources. In the U.S., the National Domestic Violence Hotline is 1-800-799-7233 (or text START to 88788) — free, confidential, 24/7. Document everything. Do not confront alone if unsafe. This guide is not legal advice. Laws vary by location. Get jurisdiction-specific help.

He's betting the kids will never see through it.

Every lie he plants is a lock. You are the one who keeps the key — your steady presence, your records, your refusal to play the game. The woman he tried to erase from their story is still here. And the kids will remember who stayed calm when the story got loud.

You are not crazy. You are the parent he is terrified they will remember.